



City Council January 5, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4dtx4loe0WM
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie City Council Special Hearing & Regular Meeting

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Special Public Hearing on Ordinance 1-26 (Seeking Additional Appropriations) [00:00:11](#)
- **Summary of Discussion:**
 - Mayor Dan Ridenower presented a request to utilize \$900,000 in saved EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) funds to support city general operations and specific community initiatives.
 - The appropriations breakdown includes: \$10,000/year (3-year extension) for the Muncie Arts and Culture Council; \$500,000 for a South Side/Industry neighborhood community center; \$65,000 for fireworks (Prairie Creek and downtown); \$125,000/year for "The Hub" (Muncie Mission); \$100,000/year (5th year) for Muncie Community Schools family navigators; and \$100,000 (4th of 5 installments) for the YWCA capital campaign.
 - **Public Input:** Rick Yenser (newsman and author) spoke, questioning the remaining EDIT funds, supporting the homeless services at The Hub, but expressing skepticism regarding funding for the school corporation and the necessity of the

proposed community center given existing empty commercial buildings. He also requested more advance public notice.

- **Disposition:** The special hearing was adjourned 00:07:43 to reconvene at the regular 7:00 PM meeting.
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2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Jeff Green called the regular Muncie City Council meeting to order for the year 2026 00:16:09.
 - **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Mr. Green, Ms. [Not explicitly named in roll call transcript, but noted as present], Mr. Macintosh, Mr. Green, Ms. Pal, Mr. Garrett, Mr. Basham (also referred to as Mr. Bash), and President Mason (noting leadership transition). (*Note: Roll call transcript reflects full council participation*).
 - *Presiding Officer:* Jeff Green (following reorganization vote).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance 00:16:35 and invocation delivered by Councilman Mack 00:16:54. Citizen recognition was postponed to next month due to holiday closures 00:17:34.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes were approved via roll call vote (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call Yes) 02:27:37.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:18:15 Council Reorganization (2026 Officers & Appointments):**
 - **President:** Jeff Green nominated by Councilman Selby, seconded by Councilman Selby. (Alternative nomination of current president by Councilman Pal, seconded by Macintosh). **Vote Disposition:** Jeff Green elected Council President.
 - **Vice President:** Mr. Dell Basham nominated. Nora Pal nominated. **Vote Disposition:** Nora Pal elected Vice President 02:22:38.
 - **Reading Secretary:** Ro Selby vs. Sarah Gillian. **Vote Disposition:** Sarah Gillian selected/voted.
 - **Legal Counsel:** Dan Gibson chose not to be retained. Arnold Law Offices (Mr. Jen Arnold) nominated and approved unanimously by roll call 02:26:10.
 - **Board & Commission Appointments:** Made for Edit Building Corporation (Watasha Barnes Griffith), Emergency Communications Board (Harold Mason/Brandon Garrett appointments), Ethics Commission (Frank Scott Jr.), Historic Preservation Committee (Sarah Gillian/Brandon Garrett), Metropolitan Planning Commission

(Dishman/Powell), Muncie Industrial Revolving Loan Fund (Macintosh), Muncie Land Bank (Brad King, John West, Hannah Rebecca Hano), Muncie Fire Merit Commission (Kevin Kohley), and Muncie Redevelopment Commission (Zayn Bishop, Seth Rollins, Roger Miller).

- **00:45:06 Ordinance 1-26: Additional Appropriations (EDIT)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenower.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Re-presented the \$900,000 EDIT appropriation package for city operations, arts, community centers, fireworks, The Hub, school navigators, and the YWCA.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced (Passed Unanimously / Roll Call) **05:22:09**.
- **00:52:43 Ordinance 2-26: Subdivision Regulations Amendment (Trees)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brandy Ingramman (Plan Commission, on behalf of Kylene Swackhammer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposes amending subdivision regulations (Article 5) to require trees in new subdivisions (at least one shade tree per front yard, two-inch minimum diameter) following recommendations from the Muncie Urban Forestry Committee and an 8-0 favorable recommendation from the Metropolitan Plan Commission.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by roll call vote **00:59:20**.
- **00:59:23 Ordinance 3-26: Amending Code Section 32.39 (Ordinance/Resolution Filing Prerequisites)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sponsored by Councilwoman Nora Pal.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requires future ordinances and resolutions to be filed directly by a council person or legal counsel to ensure accountability and transparency.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Alex Clubber, Rita Faulner, Julian Franklin, Ellen Whitehead, Cheryl Swingley, Mary Moore, Melinda Bino, Tanya Pearson, Sarah Vitali, Cameron Grubs, Audi Barber, Seth Rollins, and Dr. West spoke in strong support, emphasizing transparency, public trust, and preventing misattribution.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced via roll call vote **01:14:38**.
- **01:15:27 Ordinance 4-26: Police Department Maximum Salaries (2026)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Deputy Police Chief Chris Degan.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reflects terms of the collective bargaining agreement between city administration and the FOP (Fraternal Order of Police). Chief Degan noted staffing is projected around 108-109 officers.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Audi Barber spoke regarding the need for council review and understanding of salary figures prior to voting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced via roll call vote **01:18:19**.
- **01:18:39 Ordinance 5-26: Traffic Schedules Amendment - Westview Elementary Parking Restrictions**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Amler (Principal, Westview Elementary) and Chief Sloan.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes no-parking zones (7:00 AM to 4:00 PM) 300 feet north of Gilbert Street on surrounding side streets to mitigate severe traffic congestion, blocked driveways, and pedestrian safety hazards during school drop-off and pick-up.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Staca Biddings, John West, Stephanie Hail, and Cameron Grubs testified about dangerous traffic conditions, lack of sidewalks, and aggressive altercations among motorists in residential areas near the school.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Rules were suspended to expedite the measure (Passed Unanimously / Roll Call), and the ordinance was fully **Adopted 01:34:24**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:35:16 Paul Bartisan:** Addressed the long-delayed development of the former Borg-Warner site (closed in 2009, demolished in 2017) and asked about current plans, obstacles, and citizen facilitation for the Muncie-Yorktown corridor.
 - **01:37:00 Beth Mesner (Riverside Normal City Neighborhood Association):** Discussed ongoing infrastructure concerns on University Avenue, specifically uncurbed blocks left as mud over winter and painted center lines that create narrow, hazardous conditions for legal street parking. Reiterated neighborhood opposition to Ordinance 2925.
 - **01:41:39 Cameron Grubs:** Addressed concerns regarding offensive social media comments made by a city communications director regarding transgender individuals, urging the council to uphold Resolution 18-25 (condemning divisive and hateful rhetoric).
 - **01:46:17 Mr. Bilbury:** Criticized newly instituted procedural rules limiting public comment timing and structure, citing First Amendment rights and historical council practices.
 - **01:50:17 Chip Taylor:** Addressed the importance of digital transparency, criticizing the administration's removal of certain board/commission meetings from recorded streams and urging better online posting of board agendas, minutes, and presentation materials.
 - **01:55:32 Audi Barber:** Voiced strong opposition to newly proposed council rules that restrict public comment timing and limit public input during ordinance introductions, arguing it disenfranchises residents.
 - **01:59:13 Cheryl Swingley:** Inquired about procedural transparency, rule-posting requirements, and requested clarification on the two-minute public comment limit and resolution introduction rules.
 - **02:03:38 Sarah Vitali:** Questioned the motivations behind the new council rules regarding public comment timing and emphasized the importance of welcoming public feedback as a cornerstone of local democracy.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Mayor Ridenower reported that collective bargaining agreements have been accepted by the police and fire unions (pending final signatures), while negotiations with AFSCME remain ongoing.
- New ground rules announced by Council President Green include moving public comment to the beginning of future meetings, setting a 7:00 PM cutoff for speaker registration, limiting comments to two minutes, requiring name/address, and prohibiting public comment during ordinance introductions.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was motioned, seconded, and officially adjourned by voice vote [02:07:13](#).

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